



Little Wonderer held a magnifier beside the sink. "Can I see the tiny guests on my hands?" "Germs are far too small for just our eyes," said Big. "Even that magnifier cannot show them." They opened a book. Bacteria and viruses waited on its pages. Were these tiny guests alike?



Little paused at a yogurt cup. "Are all bacteria a problem?" "Many are helpers," said Big. "Some live happily in your gut and help with food. Others help make yogurt. Some can make people unwell." A bacterium is one whole living cell: a tiny unit with the parts it needs to live.



The next guest was much smaller. A virus is a tiny package of instructions in a coat, not a cell. It cannot make copies alone. It must borrow a living cell's machinery: the parts that do the work. "Like a program saying 'copy me?'" asked Little. "Instructions that need a cell," said Big.



Back at the sink, Little made a soft lather. Soap can pull apart the oily outer layers of many germs. It also loosens germs from skin. "Wet. Add soap. Scrub for 20 seconds. Rinse. Dry," Little said. Water carried the loosened guests away. A small habit could do a lot.

WONDER DAILY

Tiny Guests

A little book of tiny guests



Two tiny guests. One kind habit.

GRADE 3

Make a little book.

1. Print one-sided: US Letter, portrait, actual size / 100%. No fit. Headers/footers off.
2. Fold long edge to long edge; reopen. Fold short edge to short edge, then in half again. Open: eight boxes.
3. Cut only the solid center line across the middle two boxes. Keep the outer boxes joined.
4. Refold long edge to long edge, print outside. Push ends together to open a diamond, then a cross.
5. Wrap into a book with page 1 in front. Follow pages 1 to 8.



Look closely, wonder, and pause whenever you like.

Your turn

Write one command sentence for washing hands.

Example: First wet your hands, then scrub with soap for 20 seconds.